

By Al Mallette

Edison appears to be heading for a "first" in Elmira area basketball — a "first" the Spartans would just as soon wipe from their memories. Never before has an Elmira area basketball team ever gone through a season winless — and Edison appears headed that way . . . At the same time, Academy hasn't had a losing season since 1959-60 and has suffered through a mere two losing seasons in the last 25 campaigns. The way the Blue Devils have skidded this season could make it that third losing campaign . . . And down the road a piece, Smithfield-Ridgebury-Ulster (we know 'em better by SRU) may lose more games than any other Twin Tiers basketball team in modern times. SRU, at last look, was 0-17. Then there's Addison, 0-12; and Troupsburg, 0-12.

NOTE to Kip Horsburgh, Carl Fazio and new Pioneer skipper Len Johnston: Don't ask Gabe Paul to send a championship club into Elmira if you want to lure the folks to Dunn Field. Have Cleveland give you a third-place club. History proves that Elmira's greatest attendance years came when Elmira challenged for the pennant, but would up third . . . The all-time straight season attendance mark is 126,238 paid in 1951. The second best is 124,384 paid in 1941. Both Elmira teams finished third those seasons — but also they had colorful personnel, like Don Zimmer, Jack Lillis, Bobby Wilson, Gale Wade, Ed Roebuck and Bill Bourdreau in 1951 and Sal Maglie, Ray Roche, Ed Robinson, Frank Madura, Ed Kobesky, Jess Pike, Andy Cohen and Alex Monchak in 1941 . . . Incidentally, Horsburgh and Fazio have made as their motto for 1972 Elmira baseball "100,000 Or Bust." Here's one guy who hopes they break all attendance records and stay around Elmira for years to come.